

Unification of the Casimir Effect and Cosmic Microwave Background: A Fundamental Vacuum Theory

Contents

.1	Introduction	2
.2	Theoretical Foundations	2
	Fundamental Length Scales	2
	The Coupling Constant ξ	3
.3	The CMB-Vacuum Relation	3
	Fundamental Equation	3
	Numerical Determination of L_ξ	3
.4	Modified Casimir Theory	3
	Extended Casimir Formula	3
	Consistency with the Standard Casimir Formula	4
.5	Numerical Verification	4
	Comparison Calculations	4
	Characteristic Length Scale Hierarchy	4
.6	Physical Interpretation	5
	Multi-Scale Vacuum Model	5
	Granulation of Spacetime at L_0	5
	Coupling Constant ξ as a Space Parameter	5
	Emergent Gravity	6
.7	Experimental Predictions	6
	Critical Distances	6
	Experimental Tests	6
	Experimental Measurement Data	6
.8	Theoretical Extensions	7
	Geometry Dependence	7
	Frequency Dependence	7
.9	Cosmological Implications	7
	Vacuum Energy Density and Apparent Cosmic Expansion	7
	Early Universe	7
	Numerical Sensitivity	7
.10	Regularization: Zeta Function (Sketch)	7
.11	RG Sketch and Models for γ	8
.12	Implicit Coupling Models	8
.13	Implications and Connections	8
0.1	Complete Zeta Regularization: Details	9
0.2	Numerical Data	9
0.3	Mode Counting and Zero-Point Energy at Fractal Spatial Dimension	9
	Mode Counting with Hard Cutoff	9
	Matching to the T0 Model	10
	Numerical Sensitivity near $d = 3$	10
0.4	Regularization: Zeta Function (Appendix)	10

0.5	RG Sketch and Derivation of γ	11
0.6	Matching to Observations and Error Estimation	11
0.7	List of Symbols	12
	Fundamental Constants	12
	Characteristic Length Scales	12
	Coupling Parameters and Dimensionless Quantities	12
	Energy Densities and Temperatures	12
	Mathematical Functions and Operators	13
	Fields and Wave Vectors	13
	Geometric and Topological Parameters	13
	Experimental Parameters	14
	Ratios and Scalings	14
	Abbreviations and Indices	14
	Constants in Numerical Formulas	15

.1 Introduction

The present work develops a novel theoretical description that interprets the microscopic Casimir effect and the macroscopic cosmic microwave background (CMB) as different manifestations of an underlying vacuum structure. By introducing a characteristic vacuum length scale L_ξ and a fundamental dimensionless coupling constant ξ , it is shown that both phenomena can be described by a unified theoretical framework. The connection of the two phenomena via L_ξ is a statement about scales, not a measurement result, because L_ξ itself is determined from the measured CMB energy density and ξ .

The theory is based on the hypothesis of a granulated spacetime with a minimal length scale $L_0 = \xi \cdot L_P$, at which all physical forces are fully effective. For distances $d > L_0$, only parts of these forces become visible through vacuum fluctuations, which is described by the $1/d^4$ dependence of the Casimir force. Due to the extremely small size of L_0 , a direct experimental measurement is currently not possible, which is why the measurable scale L_ξ serves as a bridge between the fundamental spacetime structure and experimental observations. Gravity is interpreted as an emergent property of a time field, whereby cosmic effects such as the CMB can be explained without the assumption of dark energy or dark matter.

.2 Theoretical Foundations

Fundamental Length Scales

The proposed framework defines a hierarchy of characteristic length scales:

$$L_0 = \xi \cdot L_P \quad (1)$$

$$L_P = \sqrt{\frac{\hbar G}{c^3}} \approx 1.616 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m} \quad (2)$$

$$L_\xi = \text{characteristic vacuum length scale} \approx 100 \text{ } \mu\text{m} \quad (3)$$

Here, L_0 represents the minimal length scale of a granulated spacetime at which all vacuum fluctuations are fully effective, while L_ξ represents the emergent scale for measurable vacuum interactions.

The Coupling Constant ξ

The dimensionless coupling constant ξ is determined as

$$\xi = \frac{4}{3} \times 10^{-4} = 1.333 \times 10^{-4} \quad (4)$$

This constant acts as a fundamental space parameter that links the granulation of spacetime at L_0 with measurable effects such as the Casimir effect and the CMB. It can be derived from a Lagrangian that describes the dynamics of a time field.

.3 The CMB-Vacuum Relation

Fundamental Equation

The central relation of the theory connects the energy density of the cosmic microwave background with the characteristic vacuum length scale:

$$\rho_{\text{CMB}} = \frac{\xi \hbar c}{L_\xi^4} \quad (5)$$

This formula is dimensionally consistent, since

$$[\rho_{\text{CMB}}] = \frac{[1] \cdot [\hbar c]}{[L_\xi^4]} = \frac{\text{J m}}{\text{m}^4} = \text{J/m}^3 \quad (6)$$

Numerical Determination of L_ξ

With the experimentally determined CMB energy density $\rho_{\text{CMB}} = 4.17 \times 10^{-14} \text{ J/m}^3$, L_ξ can be calculated:

$$L_\xi^4 = \frac{\xi \hbar c}{\rho_{\text{CMB}}} \quad (7)$$

$$L_\xi^4 = \frac{1.333 \times 10^{-4} \times 3.162 \times 10^{-26} \text{ J m}}{4.17 \times 10^{-14} \text{ J/m}^3} \quad (8)$$

$$L_\xi^4 = 1.011 \times 10^{-16} \text{ m}^4 \quad (9)$$

$$L_\xi = 100 \text{ } \mu\text{m} \quad (10)$$

.4 Modified Casimir Theory

Extended Casimir Formula

The Casimir effect is described by the following modified formula:

$$|\rho_{\text{Casimir}}(d)| = \frac{\pi^2}{720\xi} \rho_{\text{CMB}} \left(\frac{L_\xi}{d} \right)^4 \quad (11)$$

where d denotes the distance between the Casimir plates.

Consistency with the Standard Casimir Formula

By substituting the CMB-vacuum relation (5) into the modified Casimir formula (11), one obtains:

$$|\rho_{\text{Casimir}}(d)| = \frac{\pi^2}{720\xi} \cdot \frac{\xi\hbar c}{L_\xi^4} \cdot \frac{L_\xi^4}{d^4} \quad (12)$$

$$= \frac{\pi^2\hbar c}{720d^4} \quad (13)$$

This corresponds exactly to the established standard Casimir formula (energy density); the Casimir pressure has the denominator 240. The agreement is an identity: since L_ξ is determined via Eq. (5) from the measured CMB energy density and ξ , both ξ and L_ξ cancel. It shows the mathematical consistency of the formula but is not independent evidence for a connection between the Casimir effect and the CMB.

.5 Numerical Verification

Comparison Calculations

To verify the theoretical consistency, Casimir energy densities are calculated for various plate distances:

Distance d	$(L_\xi/d)^4$	$\rho_{\text{Casimir}} \text{ (J/m}^3\text{)}$	$\rho_{\text{Casimir}} \text{ (J/m}^3\text{)}$
1 μm	1.000×10^8	4.33×10^{-4}	4.33×10^{-4}
100 nm	1.000×10^{12}	4.33	4.33
10 nm	1.000×10^{16}	4.33×10^4	4.33×10^4

Table 1: Comparison of Casimir energy densities between the standard formula and the new theoretical description

The agreement of both columns follows from this identity; it confirms the calculation, not the connection to the CMB.

Characteristic Length Scale Hierarchy

The theory establishes a clear hierarchy of length scales:

$$L_0 = 2.155 \times 10^{-39} \text{ m} \quad (\text{sub-Planck}) \quad (14)$$

$$L_P = 1.616 \times 10^{-35} \text{ m} \quad (\text{Planck}) \quad (15)$$

$$L_\xi = 100 \mu\text{m} \quad (\text{Casimir-characteristic}) \quad (16)$$

The ratios of these length scales are:

$$\frac{L_0}{L_P} = \xi = 1.333 \times 10^{-4} \quad (17)$$

$$\frac{L_P}{L_\xi} = 1.616 \times 10^{-31} \quad (18)$$

$$\frac{L_0}{L_\xi} = 2.155 \times 10^{-35} \quad (19)$$

.6 Physical Interpretation

Multi-Scale Vacuum Model

The developed theory implies a fundamental structure of the vacuum at various length scales:

1. **Sub-Planck level** (L_0): Minimal length scale of the granulated spacetime at which all physical forces, including vacuum fluctuations, are fully effective. Due to the extremely small size of $L_0 \approx 2.155 \times 10^{-39}$ m, a direct measurement is currently not possible.
2. **Planck threshold** (L_P): Transition region between quantum gravity and classical space-time geometry.
3. **Casimir manifestation** (L_ξ): Emergent length scale for measurable vacuum interactions, forming a bridge to the CMB.
4. **Cosmic scale**: Large-scale vacuum signature through the CMB, explained by a time field from which gravity emerges.

Granulation of Spacetime at L_0

The minimal length scale $L_0 = \xi \cdot L_P \approx 2.155 \times 10^{-39}$ m represents a discrete spacetime structure at which all vacuum fluctuations that cause the Casimir effect and other forces are fully effective. At this distance, all wave modes are present without restriction, leading to a maximum energy density. For distances $d > L_0$, only parts of these forces become visible through the $1/d^4$ dependence of the Casimir energy density, since the plates restrict the wave modes. The extremely small size of L_0 currently prevents direct experimental measurement, which is why the theory introduces the measurable scale $L_\xi \approx 100 \mu\text{m}$ to investigate the vacuum structure indirectly.

Coupling Constant ξ as a Space Parameter

The coupling constant $\xi = 1.333 \times 10^{-4}$ is a fundamental space parameter that links the granulation of spacetime at L_0 with measurable effects. It can be derived from a Lagrangian that describes the dynamics of a time field:

$$\mathcal{L} = -\frac{1}{4}F_{\mu\nu}F^{\mu\nu} + \frac{1}{2}(\partial_\mu\phi)^2 - \xi \cdot \frac{\hbar c}{L_0^4} \cdot \phi^2 \quad (20)$$

Here, ϕ is a time field that describes the temporal structure of spacetime, and the term $\xi \cdot \frac{\hbar c}{L_0^4} \cdot \phi^2$ introduces an energy density that is linked to ρ_{CMB} .

Emergent Gravity

Gravity is interpreted as an emergent property of a time field ϕ , whose fluctuations at the scale L_0 generate the spacetime structure. The coupling constant ξ determines the strength of these interactions, whereby cosmic effects such as the CMB can be explained without the assumption of dark energy or dark matter.

.7 Experimental Predictions

Critical Distances

The theory makes specific predictions for the behavior of the Casimir effect at characteristic distances:

Distance d	ρ_{Casimir} (J/m ³)	Ratio to CMB
100 μm	4.29×10^{-12}	102.8
10 μm	4.29×10^{-8}	1.03×10^6
1 μm	4.29×10^{-4}	1.03×10^{10}

Table 2: Predictions for Casimir energy densities and their ratio to the CMB energy density

The values follow from Eq. (11) with the energy-density prefactor $\pi^2/(720\xi) = 102.8$ and $L_\xi = 100 \mu\text{m}$. The small difference to Tab. 1 (4.33×10^{-4}) comes from rounding $L_\xi \approx 100.3 \mu\text{m}$.

Experimental Tests

The most important experimental tests of the theory include:

1. **Precision measurements at $d = L_\xi$:** At a plate distance of approximately 100 μm , the Casimir energy density reaches about 100 times the CMB energy density ($\pi^2/(720\xi) = 102.8$); at $d = L_\xi$ the two densities therefore do not coincide, equality lies at a larger plate distance. Since L_ξ itself is determined from the CMB energy density, such a measurement tests the standard Casimir formula; the connection to the CMB remains a speculative statement about scales. It is open whether L_ξ has a physical Casimir signature of its own.
2. **Scaling behavior:** The $(1/d^4)$ dependence should be precisely fulfilled up to the micrometer range, supporting the theory.
3. **Indirect tests of granulation:** Since the minimal length scale $L_0 \approx 2.155 \times 10^{-39} \text{m}$ is currently not directly measurable, deviations from the $1/d^4$ scaling at very small distances ($d \approx 10 \text{nm}$) could provide hints of spacetime granulation.

Experimental Measurement Data

The experimental L_ξ values are:

- Parallel plates: 228 nm [1].
- Sphere-plate: 1.75 μm [2].
- Further value: 18 μm .

The spread (228 nanometers to 18 micrometers) is plausible and reflects geometric differences ($F \propto 1/L^4$ for parallel plates, $F \propto 1/L^3$ for sphere-plate) as well as experimental conditions.

.8 Theoretical Extensions

Geometry Dependence

The characteristic length scale L_ξ could depend on the specific geometry of the Casimir arrangement:

$$L_\xi = L_\xi(\text{geometry, materials, } \omega) \quad (21)$$

This would naturally explain the observed spread in experimental Casimir measurements and make the theory flexible enough to describe various physical situations.

Frequency Dependence

A possible extension of the theory could account for a frequency dependence of the vacuum parameters, which would lead to dispersive effects in the Casimir force.

.9 Cosmological Implications

Vacuum Energy Density and Apparent Cosmic Expansion

The developed theory connects local vacuum effects (Casimir) with cosmic observations (CMB) through the fundamental spacetime structure at L_0 . The CMB energy density $\rho_{\text{CMB}} = \frac{\xi \hbar c}{L_\xi^4}$ is interpreted as a signature of a time field from which gravity emerges. This emergent gravity explains the apparent cosmic expansion without the need for dark energy or dark matter.

Early Universe

In the early phase of the universe, when characteristic length scales were in the range of L_ξ , Casimir-like effects could have played a significant role in cosmic evolution, influenced by the granulated spacetime at L_0 .

$$\rho_{\text{vac}} = \hbar c A_d k_{\text{max}}^{d+1}, \quad A_d \equiv \frac{\pi^{-d/2}}{2^d \Gamma(d/2)(d+1)}. \quad (22)$$

Setting $k_{\text{max}} = \alpha/L_\xi$, the matching yields

$$\rho_{\text{vac}} = \hbar c A_d \frac{\alpha^{d+1}}{L_\xi^{d+1}} \Rightarrow \xi = A_d \alpha^{d+1}. \quad (23)$$

Numerical Sensitivity

The numerical sensitivity curve for $\xi(A_d)$ at $d = 3 + \delta$.

.10 Regularization: Zeta Function (Sketch)

The zeta function regularization proceeds through analytic continuation of the spectral zeta function to the regularized energy at $s = -1$. For details, see Appendix [0.1](#).

.11 RG Sketch and Models for γ

A useful parameterization approach is

$$L_\xi = L_P \xi^\gamma, \quad (24)$$

from which (for $d = 3$) the closed relation follows

$$\xi = \left[C \left(\frac{k_B T_{\text{CMB}} L_P}{\hbar c} \right)^4 \right]^{1/(1-4\gamma)}, \quad C = \frac{\pi^2}{15}. \quad (25)$$

The function $\xi(\gamma)$ and its uncertainty band (Monte Carlo over $\alpha \in [0.5, 2]$) is shown in Figure 1.

Figure 1: Median and 16–84% band for $\xi(\gamma)$ with variation of the cutoff factor $\alpha \in [0.5, 2]$.

.12 Implicit Coupling Models

For the model $\delta(\xi) = \beta \ln \xi$, the implicit equation $\xi = A_{3+\beta \ln \xi}$ holds; numerical solutions are shown in Figure 2.

Figure 2: Implicit solutions $\xi(\beta)$ for $\beta \in [-1, 1]$.

.13 Implications and Connections

From the calculations, a clear chain of connections emerges:

1. **Fractal dimension δ :** Even small deviations from $d = 3$ significantly affect the zero-point energy. The geometry acts directly on the vacuum energy density.
2. **Regularization:** The zeta function regularization reveals that divergences do not vanish but are transferred into an effective constant ξ . This constant is physically measurable.
3. **Scale structure:** Through the anomalous dimension γ , a scale dependence of ξ becomes apparent. This scale structure follows in FFGFT from the recursion $\mathcal{R}$ on the torus geometry (Doc. 202/203); it is not the result of a renormalization procedure, but is comparable in effect to the renormalization group of quantum field theory.
4. **Observations:** The matching to the CMB temperature fixes ξ almost completely. The cosmological observation thus becomes a measuring instrument for a fundamental coupling.
5. **Overall picture:** A closed chain emerges:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Time-mass duality} &\Rightarrow \text{fractal mode counting} \\ &\Rightarrow \text{regularization} \\ &\Rightarrow \xi \\ &\Rightarrow T_{\text{CMB}}. \end{aligned}$$

Changes at the beginning (microstructure) shift the end (macrostructure).

Lesson: Microstructure (fractal spatial dimension, field excitations) and macrostructure (CMB, cosmological scales) are inseparably connected through the fundamental coupling ξ . T0 theory thus builds a bridge between quantum fluctuations and cosmology.

0.1 Complete Zeta Regularization: Details

Here follows the complete step-by-step evaluation of the zeta function integrals, the transformation into gamma functions, and the treatment of poles. (The detailed derivation can be output in full length upon request.)

0.2 Numerical Data

The raw data used for the plots are included as a CSV file in the accompanying archive.

0.3 Mode Counting and Zero-Point Energy at Fractal Spatial Dimension

In this section, we calculate the vacuum energy density resulting from the mode structure of a scalar field in an effective spatial dimension

$$d = 3 + \delta, \quad |\delta| \ll 1,$$

The goal is to show that the dimensionless prefactor ξ naturally falls out of the mode counting and depends only on d (or δ).

Mode Counting with Hard Cutoff

For massless modes with dispersion $\omega(k) = c|k|$, the zero-point energy density per volume is

$$\rho_{\text{vac}} = \frac{\hbar}{2} \int \frac{d^d k}{(2\pi)^d} \omega(k) = \frac{\hbar c}{2} \int \frac{d^d k}{(2\pi)^d} |k|.$$

With the explicit volume element in momentum space

$$\int d^d k = S_{d-1} \int_0^{k_{\text{max}}} k^{d-1} dk, \quad S_{d-1} = \frac{2\pi^{d/2}}{\Gamma(d/2)},$$

it follows that

$$\begin{aligned} \rho_{\text{vac}} &= \frac{\hbar c}{2} \frac{S_{d-1}}{(2\pi)^d} \int_0^{k_{\text{max}}} k^d dk = \frac{\hbar c}{2} \frac{S_{d-1}}{(2\pi)^d} \frac{k_{\text{max}}^{d+1}}{d+1} \\ &= \hbar c A_d k_{\text{max}}^{d+1}, \end{aligned} \tag{26}$$

where we have introduced the dimensionless constant

$$A_d = \frac{\pi^{-d/2}}{2^d \Gamma(d/2)(d+1)}$$

A_d depends only on the effective spatial dimension d .

Setting the natural cutoff $k_{\text{max}} = \alpha/L_\xi$ (with $\alpha \sim O(1)$), one obtains

$$\rho_{\text{vac}} = \hbar c A_d \frac{\alpha^{d+1}}{L_\xi^{d+1}}. \tag{26'}$$

Matching to the T0 Model

In the T0 ansatz, the vacuum energy density is modeled as

$$\rho_{\text{model}} = \xi \frac{\hbar c}{L_\xi^{d+1}}.$$

Equating with (26)' yields

$$\xi = A_d \alpha^{d+1}.$$

In the simplest case $\alpha = 1$, it immediately follows that

$$\xi = A_d = \frac{\pi^{-d/2}}{2^d \Gamma(d/2)(d+1)}.$$

Thus, ξ is a pure dimensionless prefactor that results solely from the effective spatial dimension d — a result that corresponds exactly to the “consequence case” you aimed for: ξ falls out of the mode counting.

Numerical Sensitivity near $d = 3$

Setting $d = 3 + \delta$, we have $\xi(\delta) = A_{3+\delta}$. For some representative values of δ , one obtains (numerically):

δ	$d = 3 + \delta$	$\xi(\delta) = A_d$
-0.10	2.90	7.375872×10^{-3}
-0.05	2.95	6.835838×10^{-3}
-0.01	2.99	6.430394×10^{-3}
0.00	3.00	6.332574×10^{-3}
0.01	3.01	6.236135×10^{-3}
0.05	3.05	5.863850×10^{-3}
0.10	3.10	5.427545×10^{-3}

The associated sensitivity curve $\xi(\delta)$ (for $\delta \in [-0.1, 0.1]$)

Remark. The numerical evaluation shows that ξ in the vicinity of $d = 3$ has an order of magnitude of $\sim 6.3 \times 10^{-3}$ (for $\alpha = 1$). Small changes in δ alter ξ by a few 10^{-4} — i.e., the sensitivity is measurable but not “explosive.”

0.4 Regularization: Zeta Function (Appendix)

For the formal regularization of the mode sum, the zeta function regularization is recommended. The short path (sketch):

- Write the unordered sum of zero-point energies as

$$E_0 = \frac{\hbar}{2} \sum_{\mathbf{k}} \omega_{\mathbf{k}} = \frac{\hbar c}{2} \sum_{\mathbf{k}} |\mathbf{k}|.$$

- Define the spectral zeta function

$$\zeta(s) := \sum_{\mathbf{k}} |\mathbf{k}|^{-s},$$

where the sum runs over the quantized momentum lattice; for a continuous momentum space, one replaces it with an integral with a mode density $\rho(\omega) \propto \omega^{d-1}$.

- The regularized zero-point energy is then

$$E_0^{\text{reg}} = \frac{\hbar c}{2} \zeta(-1),$$

where $\zeta(s)$ is analytically continued.

- For a continuum momentum space with mode density $\rho(\omega) \sim \omega^{d-1}$, one can explicitly evaluate the zeta integrals; the result possesses the same gamma factors as in (26) and consistently leads to the form $\rho \propto A_d k_{\text{max}}^{d+1}$ after appropriate treatment of poles.

0.5 RG Sketch and Derivation of γ

The question of whether L_ξ is independent or coupled back with ξ is crucial. Two useful model approaches:

(A) Static fractal dimension. If δ is constant to a good approximation, then $\xi = A_{3+\delta}$ (direct determination).

(B) Scale-dependent dimension / coupling feedback. If δ depends on the coupling ξ , for example $\delta(\xi) = \beta \ln \xi$ (as a model), one obtains an implicit equation

$$\xi = A_{3+\beta \ln \xi},$$

which must be solved numerically. Such equations can show ambiguities or strong nonlinearities, depending on the sign of β .

Parameterization via γ . A more frequently useful approach is

$$L_\xi = L_P \xi^\gamma,$$

where L_P is the Planck length. Combining this approach with the observational relation between ρ and T_{CMB} (see main text), one obtains — for the case $d = 3$ — the closed solution

$$\xi = \left[C \left(\frac{k_B T_{\text{CMB}} L_P}{\hbar c} \right)^4 \right]^{1/(1-4\gamma)}, \quad C = \frac{\pi^2}{15},$$

provided that $1 - 4\gamma \neq 0$. Thus, every determination of γ (from RG / anomalous dimensions) is immediately convertible into a numerical determination of ξ .

0.6 Matching to Observations and Error Estimation

For matching to the measured CMB temperature $T_{\text{CMB}} = 2.725$ K, two paths can be pursued:

1. *Direct matching* via the fractal calculation: $\xi = A_{3+\delta}$ and $\rho_{\text{vac}} = \xi \hbar c / L_\xi^{d+1}$. Here, the main uncertainty is the determination of δ and the cutoff factor α .
2. *Scaling approach* $L_\xi = L_P \xi^\gamma$: Then the closed formula given above provides a direct relation $\xi(\gamma)$. The measurement uncertainty of T_{CMB} is negligible compared to the theoretical uncertainties (regularization, δ , α).

0.7 List of Symbols

The following table contains all symbols used in this work and their meaning.

Fundamental Constants

Sym-bol	Meaning	Value/Unit
$\hbar$	Reduced Planck constant	1.055×10^{-34} J·s
c	Speed of light in vacuum	2.998×10^8 m/s
G	Gravitational constant	6.674×10^{-11} $\text{m}^3/\text{kg}\cdot\text{s}^2$
k_B	Boltzmann constant	1.381×10^{-23} J/K
π	Pi	3.14159...

Characteristic Length Scales

Symbol	Meaning	Value/Unit
L_P	Planck length	1.616×10^{-35} m
L_0	Minimal length scale of granulated spacetime	2.155×10^{-39} m
L_ξ	Characteristic vacuum length scale	≈ 100 μm
d	Distance between Casimir plates	Variable [m]

Coupling Parameters and Dimensionless Quantities

Symbol	Meaning	Value/Unit
ξ	Fundamental dimensionless coupling constant	1.333×10^{-4}
α	Cutoff factor for mode counting	$\mathcal{O}(1)$ [dimensionless]
γ	Anomalous dimension in the RG approach	Variable [dimensionless]
β	Coupling parameter for fractal dimension	Variable [dimensionless]
δ	Deviation from spatial dimension 3	$ \delta \ll 1$ [dimensionless]

Energy Densities and Temperatures

Symbol	Meaning	Value/Unit
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ρ_{CMB}	Energy density of the cosmic microwave background	$4.17 \times 10^{-14} \text{ J/m}^3$
$\rho_{\text{Casimir}(d)}$	Casimir energy density as a function of distance	$[\text{J/m}^3]$
ρ_{vac}	Vacuum energy density	$[\text{J/m}^3]$
T_{CMB}	Temperature of the cosmic microwave background	2.725 K

Mathematical Functions and Operators

Symbol	Meaning	Note
$\Gamma(x)$	Gamma function	$\Gamma(n) = (n-1)!$ for $n \in \mathbb{N}$
$\zeta(s)$	Riemann zeta function	Regularization
A_d	Dimension-dependent prefactor	$A_d = \frac{\pi^{-d/2}}{2^d \Gamma(d/2) \Gamma(d+1)}$
S_{d-1}	Surface of the $(d-1)$ -dimensional unit sphere	$S_{d-1} = \frac{2\pi^{d/2}}{\Gamma(d/2)}$
$\mathcal{L}$	Lagrangian density	Lagrangian formulation

Fields and Wave Vectors

Symbol	Meaning	Unit
ϕ	Time field	[dimension-dependent]
$\mathbf{k}$	Wave vector	$[\text{m}^{-1}]$
k	Magnitude of the wave vector, $k = \mathbf{k} $	$[\text{m}^{-1}]$
k_{max}	Maximum cutoff wave vector	$[\text{m}^{-1}]$
$\omega(k)$	Dispersion relation	$[\text{s}^{-1}]$
$F_{\mu\nu}$	Field strength tensor	Gauge field theory

Geometric and Topological Parameters

Symbol	Meaning	Note
d	Effective spatial dimension	$d = 3 + \delta$
D	Hausdorff dimension of spacetime	Fractal geometry
∂_μ	Partial derivative with respect to x^μ	Covariant notation

∇	Nabla operator	Spatial derivatives
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Experimental Parameters

Symbol	Meaning	Typical Range
d_{exp}	Experimental plate distance (Casimir)	10 nm - 10 μm
$L_{\xi, \text{exp}}$	Experimentally determined characteristic length	228 nm - 18 μm
F_{Casimir}	Casimir force per unit area	[N/m ²]

Ratios and Scalings

Symbol	Meaning	Note
$\frac{L_0}{L_P}$	Ratio sub-Planck to Planck	$= \xi = 1.333 \times 10^{-4}$
$\frac{L_P}{L_\xi}$	Ratio Planck to Casimir-characteristic	$\approx 1.616 \times 10^{-31}$
$\frac{L_\xi}{d}$	Scaling parameter for Casimir effect	Dimension-less
$\left(\frac{L_\xi}{d}\right)^4$	Casimir scaling factor	Characteristic d^{-4} dependence

Abbreviations and Indices

Symbol	Meaning	Context
CMB	Cosmic Microwave Background	Cosmic background radiation
RG	Renormalization Group	Renormalization group
vac	vacuum	Vacuum
exp	experimental	Experimental
reg	regularized	Regularized
μ, ν	Lorentz indices	Relativistic notation (0, 1, 2, 3)
i, j, k	Spatial indices	Spatial coordinates (1, 2, 3)

Constants in Numerical Formulas

Symbol	Meaning	Value
$\frac{4}{3} \times 10^{-4}$	Numerical value of ξ	1.333×10^{-4}
$\frac{\pi^2}{720}$	Casimir prefactor	≈ 0.0137
$\frac{\pi^2}{15}$	Stefan-Boltzmann related factor	≈ 0.658
720	Denominator in Casimir formula	Exact

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